



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:	Safety Awareness				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Safety Awareness is like almost everything else we do . . . it is learned, not instinctive. We are not born with awareness for safety concerns . . . in fact anyone who has a young toddler or grandchild knows this first hand as they see them going around doing unsafe things constantly.

We learn through various means. Some learn by doing, others by watching and some by reading. Others learn by their mistakes or the mistakes of others which is one reason we record and talk about near misses and dangerous occurrences.

So how do you know you have developed good safety awareness?

Here are some good examples of behaviours that suggest you have good safety awareness:

- Before you begin a job, you consider how to do it more safely.
- You make sure you know how and when to use personal protective equipment.
- As you work, you check your position to reduce strain on your body.
- While you are working, you become aware of any changes in the area - people coming or going, jobs beginning or ending.
- You start talking with others about safety.

Monitor yourself today and see if you have got good safety awareness. If you do not, one of the best ways to gain further awareness is to step back and take a hard look at your or a colleague's actions as they are performing a job. Watch for risky actions. You will learn and if you are watching a colleague . . . share those observations with them to help them go home safely each and every day.

Discussion Points

Have you done anything today at work today that may have been unsafe?

Have you seen anybody else do anything that could be unsafe?

Why do you think these happened and what could you do to prevent them?